But these humble proposals of planning served their purpose once independent India decided to adopt a planned economic pattern for India of which a list is given below:

The Visvesvaraya Plan

The credit of proposing the first blueprint of Indian planning is given to the popular civil engineer and the ex-Dewan of Mysore state M. Visvesvaraya —in his book *The Planned Economy of India*, published in 1934.[6] His ideas of state planning were an exercise in democratic capitalism (similar to the USA) with emphasis on industrialisation—a shift of labour from the agrarian set up to the industries targeting to double national income in one decade. Though there was no follow up by the British Government on this plan, it aroused an urge for national planning among the educated citizens of the country.

The FICCI Proposal

In 1934, a serious need of national planning was recommended by the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI), the leading organisation of Indian capitalists. Its President N.R. Sarkar proclaimed that the days of undiluted laissez-faire were gone forever and for a backward country like India, a comprehensive plan for economic development covering the whole gamut of economic activities was a necessity. Voicing the view of the leadership of the capitalist class he further called for a high powered 'National Planning Commission' to coordinate the whole process of planning so that the country could make a structural break with the past and achieve its full growth potential.[7]

By the late nineteenth century, the economic thinking of the nationalists (such as M.G. Ranade and Dadabhai Naroji) was in favour of a dominant role of state in the economy and doubted the prudence of the 'market mechanism'. This thinking was further reinforced by the Keynesian ideas in the wake of the Great Depression, the *New Deal* in the USA and the Soviet experiment in national planning. Thus the Indian capitalist class were also influenced by these events which were voiced in the FICCI articulation for the planning.